



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

yathaiva praviśeyuś ca dviṣataḥ sattra.hetubhiḥ | KAZ13.2.50ab
tathaiva ca-apagaccheyur ity uktaṃ yoga.vāmanam || 50 || KAZ13.2.50cd

— Arthaśāstra, Chapter 2 (Section 172): Drawing the Enemy out by Means of Stratagems (Chapter 2), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Arthaśāstra, specifically addressing the art of strategic withdrawal, carries echoes far beyond the battlefield and into the landscape of your own inner world. It speaks of how enemies, or in a spiritual context, negative influences and limiting beliefs, infiltrate through seemingly harmless avenues, much like spies under the guise of charitable causes. "Just as enemies may enter through means of creating a Sattra (a charitable establishment)," the text begins, emphasizing the deceptive nature of such entry points. These 'Sattra-hetubhiḥ' are the alluring distractions, the seductive temptations that promise short-term pleasure but ultimately undermine your long-term spiritual growth.

The core message lies in the second half of the verse: "so also they should be made to depart." This is the crux of the spiritual application. The Arthaśāstra, through the concept of 'yoga-vāmanam' (strategic withdrawal), advises that just as skillfully as these negative forces enter, you must learn to consciously and strategically disengage from them. This isn't about brute force or suppression; it's about skillful awareness and mindful redirection of your energy. It's about recognizing those subtle entry points – perhaps a tendency towards self-criticism disguised as self-improvement, or a craving for external validation masked as a desire for connection.

In modern life, this wisdom is profoundly relevant. You are constantly bombarded with stimuli designed to capture your attention and influence your desires. Recognizing these subtle manipulations, these modern-day 'Sattra-hetubhiḥ,' is the first step towards reclaiming your inner sovereignty. By cultivating awareness, you can skillfully withdraw your attention and energy from those forces that do not serve your highest good, creating space for genuine peace and authentic self-expression. This strategic withdrawal is not avoidance; it's a conscious choice to align your actions with your values and your spiritual aspirations. It empowers you to navigate the complexities of life with clarity, resilience, and unwavering inner strength.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly aware of the subtle ways negative influences are entering your mind, and what steps can you take today to begin a strategic withdrawal?